

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH



CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

CHAPTER 1: INDIAN CIVILIZATION AND CULTURE (BY MAHATMA GANDHI)

■ CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"Indian Civilization and Culture" is an insightful essay by Mahatma Gandhi. He highlights that Indian civilization emphasizes morality, self-control, and spiritualism, whereas Western civilization promotes materialism and endless desires. Gandhi claims that our ancient culture is unbeatable and cautions Indians against blindly copying the West to avoid total moral ruin.

✍ 15 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. How is Indian civilization different from European civilization?

Ans: Indian civilization promotes moral values, self-denial, and belief in God, whereas European civilization promotes materialism, multiplication of wants, and a godless life.

Q2. Why does Gandhi say that 'mind is a restless bird'? What makes the mind restless?

Ans: Gandhi says so because the more the mind gets, the more it wants, and it still remains unsatisfied. The uncontrolled desires and indulgence in passions make the mind restless.

Q3. Why did our ancestors dissuade us from luxuries and pleasures? Did they do the right thing?

Ans: Our ancestors knew that luxury and wealth do not bring true happiness. A rich man can be unhappy and a poor man can be happy. Yes, they did the right thing to protect our moral health.

Q4. Why did our ancestors prefer to live in small villages rather than big cities?

Ans: They saw that big cities were full of vices, thieves, robbers, and prostitutes where poor people were exploited by the rich. Therefore, they preferred small, safe villages.

Q5. What is civilization in the real sense of the term?



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Ans: In the real sense, civilization is the deliberate and voluntary restriction of human wants, which leads to true happiness, contentment, and the capacity for social service.

Q6. What does the Gujarati equivalent for civilization mean?

Ans: The Gujarati equivalent for civilization means "Good Conduct". It refers to doing one's duty with moral integrity.

Q7. How did our ancestors enjoy true Home Rule?

Ans: Our ancestors lived independently, followed their agricultural occupations, and stayed away from corrupt city settings. In this way, they enjoyed true Home Rule.

Q8. What is the charge against India by Western people? Is it justified?

Ans: The charge is that Indians are uncivilized, ignorant, and stolid, making it impossible to introduce changes. No, this charge is not justified; it is a charge against our tested merit.

Q9. Why is India's glory described as 'immovable'?

Ans: India's glory is immovable because while other great world civilizations changed or faded away, India remained firm on its ancient moral foundations.

Q10. What is the distinguishing characteristic of modern civilization?

Ans: The distinguishing characteristic of modern civilization is an indefinite multiplicity of human wants and the worship of materialism.

Q11. Why did Gandhi ji say, "I am no hater of the West"?

Ans: Gandhi ji said so because he respected the good things of the West. He was only against the blind omission of Western materialism in India.

Q12. What was the advice of our sages regarding the use of machinery?

Ans: Our sages warned that if we ran after machinery, we would become slaves to machines and lose our moral character and health.

Q13. How does Gandhi define happiness?

Ans: Gandhi defines happiness as a mental condition. It does not depend on whether a person is rich or poor, but on how they control their mind and desires.

Q14. What were the chief weapons used by Mahatma Gandhi?

Ans: The chief weapons used by Mahatma Gandhi against British rule were Truth (सत्य) and Non-violence (अहिंसा).

Q15. What will happen if India copies Western civilization blindly?

Ans: If India copies Western civilization blindly, it will mean total ruin and moral destruction for the country.

50 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

- 'Indian Civilization and Culture' is written by: (A) Mahatma Gandhi (B) Dr. Zakir Hussain (C) Pt. Nehru (D) Shiga Naoya
- Mahatma Gandhi was born in Gujarat on: (A) 2nd October 1869 (B) 30th January 1948 (C) 15th August 1947 (D) 26th January 1950
- Gandhi ji died at the hands of a fanatic on: (A) 2nd October 1948 (B) 30th January 1948 (C) 15th August 1947 (D) 26th January 1950
- Gandhi ji is popularly known as: (A) Iron Man (B) Loknayak (C) Bapu or Father of the Nation (D) Desh Ratna
- The chief weapons used by Gandhi ji against British rule were: (A) Guns and Swords (B) Truth and Non-violence (C) Nuclear bombs (D) Strikes
- The autobiography of Mahatma Gandhi is named: (A) Discovery of India (B) My Experiments with Truth (C) Hind Swaraj (D) Young India
- Gandhi ji wrote numerous important articles for: (A) The Hindu (B) Young India (C) Times of India (D) Blitz
- Indian civilization elevates the: (A) Materialism (B) Immorality (C) Moral being (D) Selfishness
- Western civilization propagates: (A) Morality (B) Immorality / Materialism (C) Spiritualism (D) Brotherhood
- "The mind is a restless _____, the more it gets the more it wants.": (A) animal (B) bird (C) cow (D) human
- Our ancestors dissuaded us from: (A) Politics (B) Education (C) Luxuries and Pleasures (D) Agriculture
- The Gujarati equivalent for civilization means: (A) Bad conduct (B) Good conduct (C) Smart work (D) Hard labor
- Civilization points out to man the: (A) path of duty (B) path of money (C) path of luxury (D) path of violence
- To observe morality is to attain mastery over our: (A) money (B) neighbors (C) minds and passions (D) enemies
- Our ancestors preferred to live happily in: (A) Cities (B) Towns (C) Villages (D) Palaces
- Our ancestors saw that large cities were a _____ and a useless encumbrance.: (A) blessing (B) snare (C) gift (D) playground
- Who were exploited by rich men in big cities, according to our ancestors?: (A) Kings (B) Poor men (C) Merchants (D) Foreigners
- Our ancestors enjoyed true _____ rule.: (A) British (B) Foreign (C) Home (D) Modern
- The common people in ancient India followed their _____ occupation.: (A) Business (B) Agriculture (C) Industry (D) Politics



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20. Which civilization is not beaten in the world?: (A) Roman (B) Greek (C) Western (D) Indian
21. The charge against India by Westerners is that her people are: (A) highly educated (B) uncivilized, ignorant, and stolid (C) very modern (D) cruel
22. What is the unique beauty of Indian civilization?: (A) It changes fast (B) It remains immovable and firm (C) It copies the West (D) It is wealthy
23. India's glory is that it remains completely: (A) movable (B) immovable (C) changing (D) forgotten
24. The word "Gibbon" in the text is associated with: (A) Italy (B) India (C) Greece (D) Egypt
25. The ancient world's famous 'Pharaohs' were the rulers of ancient: (A) Rome (B) Egypt (C) Greece (D) Japan
26. The modern world has forgotten the old civilizations of: (A) Rome and Greece (B) India (C) America (D) England
27. Western civilization has the absolute tendency to privilege: (A) morality (B) spirituality (C) materiality (D) honesty
28. Indian civilization cannot be matched because it is based on: (A) money (B) force (C) belief in God / moral foundation (D) weapons
29. Gandhi ji boldly asserts: "I am no hater of the _____.": (A) East (B) West (C) North (D) South
30. According to Gandhi ji, European civilization will mean _____ for India if copied.: (A) growth (B) ruin (C) development (D) success
31. What does modern civilization worship?: (A) Ethics (B) Material / materialism (C) Truth (D) Hard work
32. Our civilization, culture, and Swaraj depend upon: (A) multiplying wants (B) restricting wants and self-denial (C) copying West (D) earning wealth
33. Happiness is largely and essentially a: (A) physical condition (B) mental condition (C) financial condition (D) disease
34. A man is not necessarily happy because he is _____, or unhappy because he is _____.: (A) educated, uneducated (B) rich, poor (C) healthy, sick (D) tall, short
35. The values of Western civilization are best suited only to: (A) Indians (B) Europeans (C) Africans (D) Asians
36. Gandhi ji was inherently more a _____ than a politician.: (A) businessman (B) spiritual leader (C) doctor (D) scientist
37. "The distinguishing characteristic of modern civilization is an indefinite multiplicity of human _____.": (A) friends (B) houses (C) wants (D) languages
38. The invention of _____ proved to be a major milestone in our ancient development.: (A) fire (B) internet (C) computer (D) mobile phone
39. In ancient times, ordinary courts, lawyers, and doctors did not _____ people.: (A) help (B) rob / exploit (C) cure (D) respect
40. According to the text, our ancestors held that justice was tolerably: (A) costly (B) fair (C) unfair (D) cruel
41. Who used to live independently in olden days following agriculture?: (A) Rich landlords only (B) The common people (C) British officers (D) Kings
42. What does modern civilization deeply worship?: (A) Ethics (B) The brute in man (C) Nature (D) Ancestors
43. The lesson 'Indian Civilization and Culture' is structurally a/an: (A) Story (B) Drama (C) Essay (D) Biography
44. Gandhi ji returned to India from South Africa permanently in: (A) 1914 (B) 1915 (C) 1920 (D) 1947
45. From 1915 till 1948, Gandhi ji completely dominated: (A) British politics (B) Indian politics (C) South African politics (D) Social media
46. Sacrifice is the sole and ultimate aim of our ancient: (A) Politicians (B) Scientists (C) Rishis / Sages (D) Businessmen
47. "Plain living and high thinking" is the famous motto of a: (A) Western philosopher (B) Eastern philosopher (C) Modern politician (D) None of these
48. Indian civilization teaches us to be more _____ towards one another.: (A) enemy (B) angry (C) friendly (D) jealous
49. Our ancestors observed that wealth and luxury made people: (A) healthy (B) slaves to their desires (C) immortal (D) wise
50. "Nothing can equal the seeds sown by our _____.": (A) teachers (B) ancestors (C) friends (D) enemies

